

IN CONTEXT

Freemasonry

Freemasonry was fashionable in the 18th century. Aristocrats and royalty became Masons. Mozart was admitted to a Masonic lodge in 1784 and his late opera *The Magic Flute* allegedly contains Masonic symbolism and expresses Masonic ideals of universal brotherhood. From the late 18th century, Catholics and monarchists in Europe came to view the Masons as a dangerous organization, subversive of the authority of the Church and kings. It is not known whether it had such political significance for Mozart.



MASONIC INITIATION WITH MOZART SEATED
ON THE FAR LEFT

Creative intensity

In the first half of the 1780s, Mozart's compositional output